

- **Launch the command prompt as administrator by right-clicking on it in the start menu and clicking on Run as Administrator.**

Since the steps we are performing will write directly to the pendrive it needs to be done with Administrator privileges.

- **Type diskpart and press [Enter].**

The command line utility “diskpart” is a powerful disk partitioning utility which is included with Windows. It can be used to perform many advanced partitioning operations. It can be used for creating / removing / shrinking / growing partitions. It can also be used for formatting pendrives in NTFS on Windows XP. However for the steps that follow, the Windows XP version of diskpart will not be sufficient. You can run the command from the recovery mode from a Windows Vista / 7 disc though.

- **Type “list volume” press enter**

This will list the volumes on the system. This will list each and every drive / partition on your computer and will list its volume number, drive letter label etc. Note the volume number for the pendrive you just formatted.

- **Type “select volume <pendrive volume number>” and press enter**

This will select the pendrive volume so that you can perform operations on it.

- **Type “active” and press enter**

This will set the “active” flag on the pendrive volume, without which you cannot boot from it.

- **Exit from diskpart using the “exit” command**

- **Insert the Windows Vista / 7 disc**

- **In the command prompt navigate to the “boot” directory on your DVD.**

- **Type “bootsect.exe /nt60 <pendrive letter>”**

The bootsect utility will transfer the boot sector to the pendrive so that it becomes bootable. The “/nt60” parameter is to specify that the Windows Vista-compatible boot-code needs to be applied.

- **Now copy all the files from the Windows Vista / 7 DVD to the root of the pendrive.**

You now have a bootable pendrive with the Windows Vista or Windows 7 setup. Booting into the recovery mode, and even installing Windows Vista or